

Evidence Axis

telli Evidence Appendix

Gift #14 | Public competitive evidence | Checked 2 Sep 2026

Scope. This appendix supports the Executive Brief. It tests one live telli comparison surface against dated and current public evidence from ElevenLabs, with a narrow focus on outbound workflow capability, agent-builder accessibility, and the historical technology-layer relationship. It is not a full voice-AI market map.

1. Claim legend

Label	Meaning
FACT	Directly supported by cited public evidence.
INFERENCE	Reasoned interpretation from verified facts. Not presented as a proven internal state.
NOT ESTABLISHED	Searched or considered, but not proven by the public evidence reviewed.

2. Final findings

Finding 1 - The outbound boundary appears to have been too broad before telli's own January 2026 cutoff. FACT: telli's live ElevenLabs page says the platform has limited batch interactions, no built-in campaign management, and should not be chosen for outbound sales. FACT: ElevenLabs launched a documented Batch Calling product on 28 May 2025 with recipient-list upload, personalization variables, scheduling, monitoring, reporting and API access. FACT: on 3 Sep 2025 ElevenLabs said customers were using Agents to qualify leads and run outbound calling at scale. INFERENCE: the blanket outbound exclusion was broader than the public evidence available before telli's stated snapshot.

Finding 2 - The developer/no-code boundary followed a different timeline. FACT: on 3 Sep 2025 ElevenLabs still listed a visual workflow builder as coming soon. FACT: on 17 Feb 2026 ElevenAgents for Support described workflows without code and a no-code interface for non-technical teams. FACT: the current ElevenLabs sales page advertises no-code call flows, an intuitive drag-and-drop builder, sales templates, and Salesforce/HubSpot plus calendar integration. INFERENCE: telli's developer-focused framing may have been more defensible around the original snapshot, but has since materially weakened.

Guardrail: The evidence does not establish feature parity, superior product quality, lost deals, or that telli's entire January benchmark was wrong. It isolates specific public claims whose evidence status differs.

3. Source register

ID	Source	Class	Date / location	Use
S1	telli - ElevenLabs Review & Best Alternatives	Company / competitor-authored	telli.com, live; checked 2 Sep 2026	Live decision guide, workflow score/narrative, builder framing, January 2026 methodology
S2	ElevenLabs - Introducing batch calling for Conversational AI	Competitor primary	28 May 2025	Self-serve outbound batch feature: CSV/XLS, variables, scheduling, monitoring, reporting, API
S3	ElevenLabs - Introducing ElevenLabs Agents	Competitor primary	3 Sep 2025	Complete-platform framing; lead qualification; outbound calling at scale; visual workflow builder coming soon
S4	TechCrunch - telli pre-seed profile	Independent media with direct CEO attribution	15 Apr 2025	Historical use of ElevenLabs or Cartesia for cloning voices used by telli
S5	ElevenLabs - Series D announcement	Company / primary	4 Feb 2026	\$500M Series D; \$11B valuation; investment in ElevenAgents across CX, sales, marketing, internal workflows
S6	ElevenLabs - Introducing ElevenAgents for Support	Competitor primary	17 Feb 2026	Workflows without code; non-technical teams update in no-code interface
S7	ElevenLabs - AI Phone Agent for Sales & SDR Teams	Competitor primary	Current; checked 2 Sep 2026	Outbound sales, batch calling, voicemail detection, no-code call flows, CRM/calendar integrations
S8	ElevenLabs - How our AI SDR qualifies leads in minutes	Competitor primary	2 Sep 2026	Dom inbound production proof; \$1M+ qualified pipeline; 92% accuracy; 180 SDR hours; outbound is next step

Source hygiene. The TechCrunch URL used here is the corrected /telli-a-yc-alum-raises-pre-seed-funding-for-its-ai-voice-agents/ path. No LinkedIn evidence is used.

4. Claim map

ID	Status	Allowed claim	Evidence
C01	FACT	telli says ElevenLabs is not ideal for end-to-end call automation/workflow management.	S1
C02	FACT	telli labels the Agent Builder developer-focused and says it lacks an easy-to-use builder.	S1
C03	FACT	telli says not to choose ElevenLabs for full call automation or outbound sales/support operations.	S1
C04	FACT	telli says its benchmark uses public evidence as of January 2026.	S1
C25	FACT	ElevenLabs shipped Batch Calling on 28 May 2025 with CSV/XLS upload, dynamic variables, scheduling, monitoring, reporting and API access.	S2
C06	FACT	By 3 Sep 2025 ElevenLabs said customers were qualifying leads and running outbound calling at scale.	S3
C07	FACT	On 3 Sep 2025 the visual workflow builder was still listed as coming soon.	S3
C08	INFERENCE	The blanket outbound exclusion appears overbroad relative to evidence available before the cutoff.	S1-S3
C09	INFERENCE	The developer-focused characterization may have been more defensible around the original snapshot.	S1,S3
C10	FACT	By 17 Feb 2026 non-technical teams could update workflows in a no-code interface.	S6
C11	FACT	Current sales product advertises no-code drag-and-drop call flows and sales templates.	S7
C12	FACT	Current sales product advertises outbound campaigns/cold calling, batch calling and voicemail detection.	S7
C13	FACT	Current product advertises Salesforce/HubSpot updates and calendar sync.	S7
C14	INFERENCE	telli's current developer-focused/no-code framing has materially weakened since its stated snapshot.	S1,S6,S7
C15	FACT	In Apr 2025 telli's CEO said voices were cloned using ElevenLabs or Cartesia.	S4

ID	Status	Allowed claim	Evidence
C16	NOT ESTABLISHED	telli still uses ElevenLabs today.	DO NOT CLAIM
C18	FACT	Dom handled \$1M+ qualified pipeline, 92% accuracy and saved 180 SDR hours in the reported month.	S8
C19	FACT	Dom is inbound today; outbound sequences are described as a next step.	S8
C20	NOT ALLOWED	Dom proves current outbound production performance.	DO NOT CLAIM
C21	NOT ALLOWED	telli's January benchmark was entirely wrong.	DO NOT CLAIM
C22	NOT ALLOWED	ElevenLabs has parity with telli.	DO NOT CLAIM

5. Finding 1 evidence - outbound and campaign workflow

Evidence point	Status	Source
telli Workflow Automation is scored 2.0/5 and says ElevenLabs has limited batch interactions.	FACT	S1
telli says ElevenLabs is not designed for scheduling, callbacks or multi-step automation and requires external tools for full automation.	FACT	S1
telli's Pros/Cons says "No built-in automation or campaign management."	FACT	S1
telli says do not choose ElevenLabs if you need full call automation or run outbound sales/support operations.	FACT	S1
ElevenLabs Batch Calling launched 28 May 2025 and automates multiple concurrent outbound calls.	FACT	S2
Batch Calling includes CSV/XLS upload, dynamic variables, scheduling, real-time monitoring, reports and API access.	FACT	S2
ElevenLabs said on 3 Sep 2025 that customers were qualifying leads and running outbound calling at scale.	FACT	S3
The live telli outbound exclusion is broader than pre-cutoff public evidence supports.	INFERENCE	S1-S3

Guardrail. Do not state that ElevenLabs had parity with telli in May or September 2025. The specific conclusion is about the breadth of telli's buyer-facing exclusion, not the overall platform score.

Timeline

Date	Observed public state	EA read
28 May 2025	Batch Calling ships with self-serve list upload, personalization, scheduling, monitoring, reporting and API.	Specific outbound campaign capability existed before the benchmark cutoff.
3 Sep 2025	Agents described as complete platform; customers use it for lead qualification and outbound calling at scale. Visual workflow builder still coming soon.	Outbound capability and builder usability were not on the same maturity clock.
Jan 2026	telli says benchmark reflects this snapshot.	Outbound exclusion must be read against capabilities that were already public by then.

Decision interpretation

INFERENCE. The low-regret action is not simply to add a Batch Calling tick. It is to rewrite the outbound comparison around narrower, durable differences that remain true even when ElevenLabs adds campaign and telephony features.

6. Finding 2 evidence - builder / no-code

Evidence point	Status	Source
telli currently labels ElevenLabs' Agent Builder "Developer-Focused" and says it lacks an easy-to-use builder.	FACT	S1
On 3 Sep 2025 ElevenLabs listed the visual workflow builder as "coming soon."	FACT	S3
On 17 Feb 2026 ElevenAgents for Support launched workflows "without code."	FACT	S6
The same Feb 2026 release says non-technical teams can update workflows, knowledge and guardrails in a no-code interface.	FACT	S6
Current sales page advertises no-code call flows with an intuitive drag-and-drop builder.	FACT	S7
Current page advertises templates for SDR, appointment setting and collections.	FACT	S7
Current page advertises Salesforce/HubSpot updates and calendar sync.	FACT	S7
The developer-focused/no-code distinction has materially weakened since the stated snapshot.	INFERENCE	S1,S3,S6,S7

Wording lock. Allowed: "may have been more defensible around the January snapshot" and "has since weakened." Not allowed: "the January builder score was wrong" or "ElevenLabs now has builder parity."

7. Strategic context - relationship boundary

Evidence point	Status	Source
TechCrunch reports CEO Finn zur Muehlen said telli voices were cloned using ElevenLabs or Cartesia.	FACT - independent / direct attribution	S4
ElevenLabs raised \$500M at an \$11B valuation and said it would double down on ElevenAgents across CX, sales, marketing and internal workflows.	FACT - primary	S5
Current telli use of ElevenLabs is not established.	NOT ESTABLISHED	-
A technology layer used by telli historically has expanded into the operational layer telli now compares against.	INFERENCE	S1,S3-S5,S7

8. Fresh proof and constrained use

Fresh primary evidence, 2 Sep 2026. ElevenLabs reports that its internal AI SDR, Dom, handled \$1M+ in qualified pipeline in one month, reached 92% qualification accuracy and saved 180 SDR hours. This is evidence that ElevenAgents is being used in a production sales workflow at ElevenLabs itself.

Critical boundary. Dom handles inbound today. The article says outbound sequences such as initial outreach and follow-up are a next step. Do not use Dom as proof that ElevenLabs has already proven outbound SDR performance in production. Current outbound capability is supported separately by the product pages and the 2025 Batch Calling release.

9. Public comparison system - follow-on question

The live telli page links an eight-provider comparison set: Vapi, Regal AI, Synthflow, Retell, Fonio, Parloa, Bland and ElevenLabs. This brief tests only ElevenLabs. It does not establish that the other seven pages are stale.

Paid decision frontier: Which claims across the full public comparison layer should telli defend, narrow, retire or rebuild when each page is tested against current competitor product state, sales objections and internal win/loss evidence?

10. Dropped or constrained items

Item	Decision	Reason
"Fastest-growing part of ElevenLabs"	Dropped	No sufficiently strong direct evidence found for the exact claim.
28 May 2026 no-code citation	Dropped / corrected	The 28 May article is 2025 Batch Calling. No-code support evidence is 17 Feb 2026.
LinkedIn hackathon relationship	Dropped	Not required; no independently fetched primary evidence used.
"Current supplier became competitor"	Not used	Only historical 2025 use is established; current relationship is unknown.
"Dom proves outbound"	Not used	Dom is inbound today; outbound sequences are next step.
"ElevenLabs has parity"	Not used	Feature/capability evidence does not establish full platform parity or quality equivalence.

11. Method and QA notes

- Research was limited to public sources. No private telli or ElevenLabs data was used.
- Primary sources are treated as evidence of what each vendor publicly states, not independent proof of product quality.
- The two timelines are intentionally separated: outbound/campaign capability versus builder/no-code accessibility.
- Absolute statements were narrowed where the evidence only supports an inference.
- No claim is made about lost deals, buyer trust damage, parity, or current supplier status.
- The brief is designed to create a decision question, not to prescribe telli's internal strategy from public evidence alone.